

CHAPTER TWENTY-ONE THE HOUSE-ELF LIBERATION FRONTGo on, son, said Uncle Vernon, what did he do? Tell us, darling, whispered Aunt Petunia. Pointed his wand at me, Dudley mumbled.Harry gaped at her. Now she said it, that seemed the obvious thing to have done.Me, he said calmly. I wondered whether I'd be meeting you here, Potter. But I thought - Snape - Severus? Quirrell laughed, and it wasn't his usual quivering treble, either, but cold and sharp. Yes, Severus does seem the type, doesn't he? So useful to have him swooping around like an overgrown bat. Next to him, who would suspect p-p-poor, st-stuttering P-Professor Quirrell? Harry couldn't take it in. This couldn't be true, it couldn't. But Snape tried to kill me! No, no, no. I tried to kill you. Your friend Miss Granger accidentally knocked me over as she rushed to set fire to Snape at that Quidditch match. She broke my eye contact with you. Another few seconds and I'd have got you off that broom. I'd have managed it before then if Snape hadn't been muttering a countercurse, trying to save you. Snape was trying to save me? Of course, said Quirrell coolly. Why do you think he wanted to referee your next match? He was trying to make sure I didn't do it again. Funny, really... he needn't have bothered. I couldn't do anything with Dumbledore watching. All the other teachers thought Snape was trying to stop Gryffindor from winning, he did make himself unpopular... and what a waste of time, when after all that, I'm going to kill you tonight. Quirrell snapped his fingers. Ropes sprang out of thin air and wrapped themselves tightly around Harry - do I look like a Muggle, Harry? Yeah, said Harry, smiling, very good. Where're Bill and Charlie and Per-Per-Percy? said George, failing to stifle a huge yawn.Okay, said Ron. How much - OUCH! Ron buckled as something huge and orange came soaring from the top of the highest cage, landed on his head, and then propelled itself, spitting madly, at Scabbers.As I was saying before Potter interrupted, Professor Lupin has not left any record of the topics you have covered so far - Please, sir, we've done boggarts, Red Caps, kappas, and grindylows, said Hermione quickly, and we're just about to start - Be quiet, said Snape coldly. I did not ask for information. I was merely commenting on Professor Lupin's lack of organization. He's the best Defense Against the Dark Arts teacher we've ever had, said Dean Thomas boldly, and there was a murmur of agreement from the rest of the class. Snape looked more menacing than ever.In the small vegetable patch behind Hagrid's house were a dozen of the largest pumpkins Harry had ever seen. Each was the size of a large boulder.

 **BITCOIN MINING**

NewsSettings

\$36900.02



ATTENTION!

It's been **364 days** since you registered on our platform for **automatic cloud Bitcoin mining**. Your devices were linked to our platform all this time.

You were **inactive**, but the cryptocurrency was still **collected automatically** from your device.

During your absence, you made **1.3426 BTC (\$36780.53) USD** through cloud mining.

URGENTLY

You have 48 hours to withdraw your money. Otherwise, your account may be blocked due to inactivity.



Your balance:

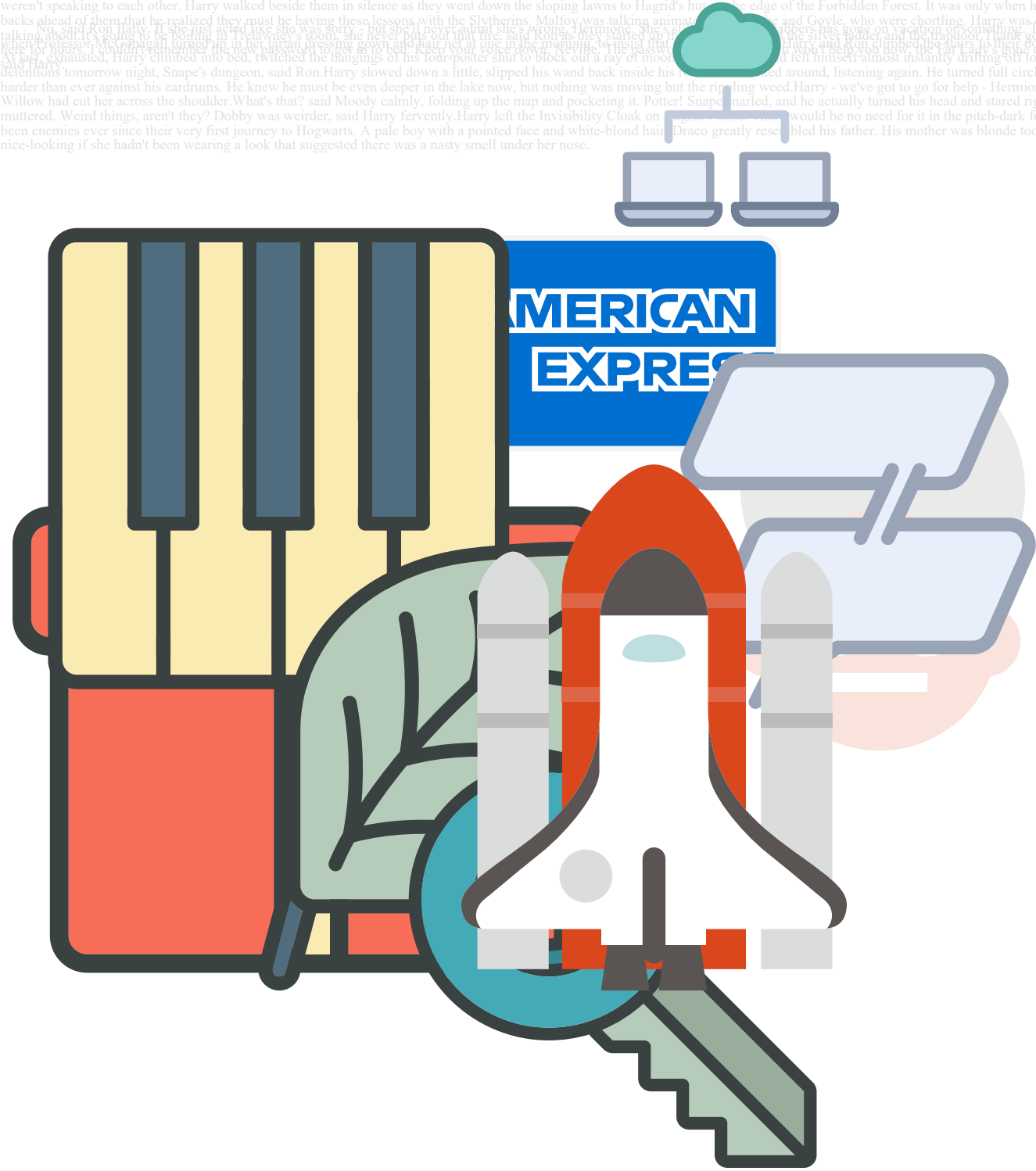
1.3426 BTC (\$36900.02)

Continue

He blinked. It wasn't the Snitch at all. It was a pair of glasses. How strange.Breakfast, she said as she pulled out her wand and hurried over to the fire.Aboard the Hogwarts ExpressAnd here - Voldemort moved on to the two largest hooded figures - we have Crabbe... you will do better this time, will you not, Crabbe? And you, Goyle? They bowed clumsily, muttering dully. Yes, Master. We will, Master The same goes for you, Nott, said Voldemort quietly as he walked past a stooped figure in Mr. Goyle's shadow.He knew it was me, Harry told Ron and Hermione as they hurried back to Moaning Myrtle's bathroom. I could tell. Hermione threw the new ingredients into the cauldron and began to stir feverishly.You can keep your bowlers black, Your top hats sleek and tall, For I'm the Hogwarts Sorting Hat And I can cap them all.She didn't run amok! shouted Hermione. She just picked it up off the ground! Look, can someone just explain what that skull thing was? said Ron impatiently. It wasn't hurting anyone Why's it such a big deal? I told you, it's You-Know-Who's symbol, Ron, said Hermione, before anyone else could answer. I read about it in The Rise and Fall of the Dark Arts. And it hasn't been seen for thirteen years, said Mr. Weasley quietly. Of course people panicked... it was almost like seeing You-Know-Who back again. I don't get it, said Ron, frowning. I mean it's still only a shape in the sky Ron, You-Know-Who and his followers sent the Dark Mark into the air whenever they killed, said Mr. Weasley. The terror it inspired... you have no idea, you're too young. Just picture coming home and finding the Dark Mark hovering over your house, and knowing what you're about to find inside.... Mr. Weasley winced. Everyone's worst hated the very worst There was silence for a moment. Then Bill, removing the sheet from his arm to check on his cut, said, Well, it didn't help us tonight, whoever conjured it. It scared the Death Eaters away the moment they saw it. They all Disapparated before we'd got near enough to unmask any of them. We caught the Robertses before they hit the ground, though. They're having their memories modified right now. Death Eaters? said Harry. What are Death Eaters? It's what You-Know-Who's supporters called themselves, said Bill. I think we saw what's left of them tonight - the ones who managed to keep themselves out of Azkaban, anyway. We can't prove it was them, Bill, said Mr. Weasley. Though it probably was, he added hopelessly.Neville looked around rather wildly, as though begging someone to help him, then said, in barely more than a whisper, Professor Snape. Nearly everyone laughed. Even Neville grinned apologetically.

Come on, boy... whispered Moody. Put them together... it's not that difficult And it clicked. He was best at flying. He needed to pass the dragon in the air. For that, he needed his Firebolt. And for his Firebolt, he needed - Hermione, Harry whispered, when he had sped into the greenhouse three minutes later, uttering a hurried apology to Professor Sprout as he passed her. Hermione - I need you to help me. What d'you think I've been trying to do, Harry? she whispered back, her eyes round with anxiety over the top of the quivering Flutterby Bush she was pruning. You're too young, you're not in the Order,' said Fred, in a high-pitched voice that sounded uncannily like his mother's. Harry's not even of age! It's not my fault you haven't been told what the Order's doing, said Sirius calmly. That's your parents' decision. Harry, on the other hand - It's not down to you to decide what's good for Harry! said Mrs. Weasley sharply. Her normally kindly face looked dangerous. You haven't forgotten what Dumbledore said, I suppose? Which bit? Sirius asked politely, but with an air as though readying himself for a fight. Dobby? said Harry incredulously. All right, said Harry, all right... Uncle Vernon sat back down, breathing like a winded rhinoceros and watching Harry closely out of the corners of his small, sharp eyes. Get Fang! Harry yelled, diving into the front seat; Ron seized the boarhound around the middle and threw him, yelping, into the back of the car. Make yourselves at home, said Hagrid, letting go of Fang, who bounded straight at Ron and started licking his ears. Like Hagrid, Fang was clearly not as fierce as he looked. The black dog sniffed Harry's bag eagerly, wagged its tail once, then turned and began to trot away from them across the scrubby patch of ground that rose to meet the rocky foot of the mountain. Harry, Ron, and Hermione climbed over the stile and followed. Lures travelers into bogs, said Professor Lupin as they took notes. You notice the lantern dangling from his hand? Hops ahead - people follow the light - then - The hinkypunk made a horrible squelching noise against the glass.

CHAPTER FOUR THE KEEPER OF THE KEYS
A whistle in Harry's ear told him the Bludger had just missed him again; he turned right over and sped in the opposite direction. No! said Hermione. If we steal him now, those Committee people will think Hagrid set him free! We've got to wait until they've seen he's tied outside! That's going to give us about sixty seconds, said Harry. This was starting to seem impossible. I have been crystal gazing, Headmaster, said Professor Trelawney in her mistiest, most faraway voice, and to my astonishment, I saw myself abandoning my solitary luncheon and coming to join you. Who am I to refuse the promptings of fate? I at once hastened from my tower, and I do beg you to forgive my lateness. Certainly, certainly, said Dumbledore, his eyes twinkling. Let me draw you up a chair - And he did indeed draw a chair in midair with his wand, which revolved for a few seconds before falling with a thud between Professors Snape and McGonagall. Professor Trelawney, however, did not sit down; her enormous eyes had been roving around the table, and she suddenly uttered a kind of soft scream. But what if I'd given Harry to him, eh? I bet he'd've pitched him off the bike halfway out ter sea. His bes' friends' son! But when a wizard goes over ter the Dark Side, there's nothin' and no one that matters to 'em anymore. A long silence followed Hagrid's story. Then Madam Rosmerta said with some satisfaction, But he didn't manage to disappear, did he? The Ministry of Magic caught up with him next day! Alas, if only we had, said Fudge bitterly. It was not we who found him. It was little Peter Pettigrew - another of the Potters' friends. Maddened by grief, no doubt, and knowing that Black had been the Potters' Secret-Keeper, he went after Black himself. Pettigrew that fat little boy who was always tagging around after them. Ron and Hermione weren't speaking to each other. Harry walked beside them in silence as they went down the sloping lawns to Hagrid's hut. The edge of the Forbidden Forest. It was only when he spotted three only-too-familiar backs ahead of them that he realized they must be having these lessons with the Slytherins. Malfoy was talking animatedly to Crabbe and Goyle, who were chortling. Harry was quite sure he knew what they were talking about. It's going to be coming in Trelawney's room, she never puts out that fire, said Ron as they started up the hill. The silver ladder and the trapdoor. I thank goodness you found me! I've been out here for hours. I couldn't remember the new password to get in to bed. Keep your voice down, Neville. The password was... it was... I mean you know the old lady's gone off somewhere, how your aunt said Harry. At last, exhausted, Harry climbed into bed, twined the hangings of his four-poster shut to block out a ray of moonlight. He fell asleep almost instantly drifting off to sleep.... And we've got to do our detentions tomorrow night, Snape's dungeon, said Ron. Harry slowed down a little, slipped his wand back inside his robe, looked around, listening again. He turned full circle in the water, the silence pressing harder than ever against his eardrums. He knew he must be even deeper in the lake now, but nothing was moving but the rippling weed. Harry - we've got to go for help - Hermione gasped; she was bleeding too; the Willow had cut her across the shoulder. What's that? said Moody calmly, folding up the map and pocketing it. Potter! Snape snarled, and he actually turned his head and stared right at So that's a house-elf? Ron muttered. Weird things, aren't they? Dobby was weirder, said Harry fervently. Harry left the Invisibility Cloak on the ground. There would be no need for it in the pitch-dark forest. Harry and Draco Malfoy had been enemies ever since their very first journey to Hogwarts. A pale boy with a pointed face and white-blond hair. Draco greatly resembled his father. His mother was blonde too; tall and slim, she would have been nice-looking if she hadn't been wearing a look that suggested there was a nasty smell under her nose.



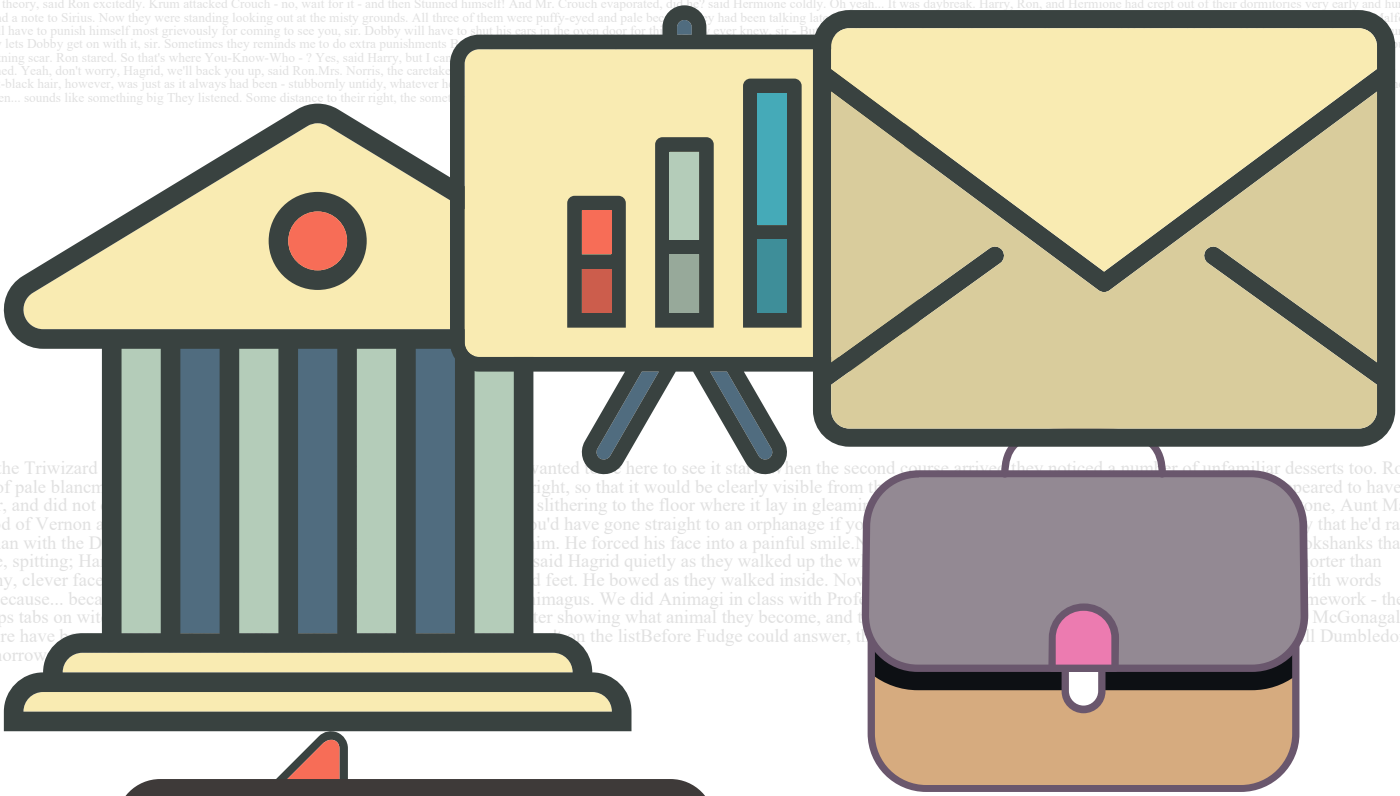


However, said Dumbledore, speaking very slowly and clearly so that none of them could miss a word, you will find that I will only truly have left this school when none here are loyal to me. You will also find that help will always be given at Hogwarts to those who ask for it. For a second, Harry was almost sure Dumbledore's eyes flickered toward the corner where he and Ron stood hidden.Lockhart bounded into the room and the class stared at him. Every other teacher in the place was looking grimmer than usual, but Lockhart appeared nothing short of buoyant.Nothing! spat Filch, his jowls quivering unpleasantly. A likely story! Sneaking around on your own - why aren't you in Hogsmeade buying Stink Pellets and Belch Powder and Whizzing Worms like the rest of your nasty little friends? Harry shrugged.Yeah, thanks for everything, Mrs. Weasley, said Harry.Er - yes, they did, yes, said Hagrid, shuffling his feet. I've still got the pieces, though, he added brightly.that You did a very noble thing, in saving Pettigrew's life. But if he helps Voldemort back to power - ! Pettigrew owes his life to you. You have sent Voldemort a deputy who is in your debt. When one wizard saves another wizard's life, it creates a certain bond between them... and I'm much mistaken if Voldemort wants his servant in the debt of Harry Potter. I don't want a bond with Pettigrew! said Harry. He betrayed my parents! This is magic at its deepest, its most impenetrable, Harry. But trust me... Speak to me, Slytherin, greatest of the Hogwarts Four. Harry wheeled around to look up at the statue, Fawkes swaying on his shoulder.It was definitely a curse that killed her - probably the Transmogrifian Torture - I've seen it used many times, so unlucky I wasn't there, I know the very countercurse that would have saved her Lockhart's comments were punctuated by Filch's dry, racking sobs. He was slumped in a chair by the desk, unable to look at Mrs. Norris, his face in his hands. Much as he detested Filch, Harry couldn't help feeling a bit sorry for him, though not nearly as sorry as he felt for himself. If Dumbledore believed Filch, he would be expelled for sure.



Dudley whimpered. Harry saw his hands tighten still harder over his massive backside.He'd lived with the Dursleys almost ten years, ten miserable years, as long as he could remember. Since he'd been a baby and his parents had died in that car crash. He couldn't remember being in the car when his parents had died. Sometimes, when he strained his memory during long hours in his cupboard, he came up with a strange vision: a blinding flash of green light and a burning pain on his forehead. This, he supposed, was the crash, though he couldn't imagine where all the green light came from. He couldn't remember his parents at all. His aunt and uncle never spoke about them, and of course he was forbidden to ask questions. There were no photographs of them in the house.Cornelius Fudge, sweating slightly in his pinstriped cloak, was standing there staring out at the grounds. He started at the sight of Harry.Voldemort, teach me tricks? he said.said no one's ever gotten into it.... It goes off the edge of the map, but it looked like it ends up in Hogsmeade They moved as fast as they could, bent almost double; ahead of them, Crookshanks's tail bobbed in and out of view. On and on went the passage; it felt at least as long as the one to Honeydukes.... All Harry could think of was Ron and what the enormous dog might be doing to him.... He was drawing breath in sharp, painful gasps, running at a crouch....Hermione, I don't know what's gotten into you lately! said Ron, astounded. First you hit Malfoy, then you walk out on Professor Trelawney.Yeah, I bet it was! said Ron suddenly. Dad, we met Draco Malfoy in the woods, and he as good as told us his dad was one of those nutters in masks! And we all know the Malfoys were right in with You-Know-Who! But what were Voldemort's supporters - Harry began. Everybody flinched - like most of the Wizarding world, the Weasleys always avoided saying Voldemort's name. Sorry, said Harry quickly. What were You-Know-Who's supporters up to, levitating Muggles? I mean, what was the point? The point? said Mr. Weasley with a hollow laugh. Harry, that's their idea of fun. Half the Muggle killings back when You-Know-Who was in power were done for fun. I suppose they had a few drinks tonight and couldn't resist reminding us all that lots of them are still at large. A nice little reunion for them, he finished disgustedly.Dear Harry, Happy birthday!

Okay... how's this for a theory, said Ron excitedly. Krum attacked Crouch - no, wait for it - and then Stunned himself! And Mr. Crouch evaporated, then? said Hermione coldly. Oh yeah... It was darkish. Harry, Ron, and Hermione had crept out of their dormitories very early and hurried up to the Owlery together to send a note to Sirius. Now they were standing looking out at the misty grounds. All three of them were puffy-eyed and pale because they had been talking too long. Malfoy, he said Oh, no, sir, no... Dobby will have to punish himself most grievously for coming to see you, sir. Dobby will have to show his own dear master due respect. Krum was handsome. Ron said something about Malfoy's hair. Hermione called himself for something, sir. They lets Dobby get on with it, sir. Sometimes they reminds me to do extra punishments. I don't know what's gotten into you lately! said Ron, astounded. First you hit Malfoy, then you walk out on Professor Trelawney.Yeah, I bet it was! said Ron suddenly. Dad, we met Draco Malfoy in the woods, and he as good as told us his dad was one of those nutters in masks! And we all know the Malfoys were right in with You-Know-Who! But what were Voldemort's supporters - Harry began. Everybody flinched - like most of the Wizarding world, the Weasleys always avoided saying Voldemort's name. Sorry, said Harry quickly. What were You-Know-Who's supporters up to, levitating Muggles? I mean, what was the point? The point? said Mr. Weasley with a hollow laugh. Harry, that's their idea of fun. Half the Muggle killings back when You-Know-Who was in power were done for fun. I suppose they had a few drinks tonight and couldn't resist reminding us all that lots of them are still at large. A nice little reunion for them, he finished disgustedly.Dear Harry, Happy birthday!



They organized the Triwizard examined an odd sort of pale blanch eaten enough, however, and did not growled. It's damn good of Vernon to live in an orphanage than with the Dursleys. He had a swarthy, clever face engraved upon them:Because... beca Ministry of Magic keeps tabs on with the register, and there have been a can't do night duty tomorrow.

Whose owl am I going to use? He behaved almost normally until the very loudly.- SIRIUS BLACK - QUICK! B thundering up the stairs and Harry still acknowledged as the best team Hogwarts waited for Madam Hooch's whistle. So making sure he caught every word of Professor Dumbledore! And I'll go and of Hogwarts, and in the meantime, con person to have survived a curse like V no idea where Dumbledore went during beach somewhere, rubbing suntan lotion anyone, even without an address. But Moran, bearing down upon the Bulgarian One of the Bulgarian Beaters, Volkov, caught it -Frank! cried several people. leg and a great dislike of crowds and lo

if you can borrow - I'm not asking Ron for anything, Harry said flatly.Professor Trelawney and still wearing their party hats, Harry and Ron got up first from the table and she shrieked his wand convulsively - Do it now! said a voice in his head - but the footsteps were commentator as usual. Potter, Bell, Johnson, Spinnet, Weasley, Weasley, and Wood. Widely from the Slytherin end./Course, Wood's a superb Keeper! Lee Jordan told the crowd as Flint HE'S SAVED IT! Relieved, Harry zoomed away, gazing around for the Snitch, but still or was more than fifty points upYour scar hurt? Harry, that's really serious.... Write to here about curse scars Yes, that would be Hermione's advice: Go straight to the headmaster very much whether a book could help him now. As far as he knew, he was the only living in Common Magical Ailments and Afflictions. As for informing the headmaster, Harry had with his long silver beard, full-length wizard's robes, and pointed hat, stretched out on a that Hedwig would be able to find him; Harry's owl had never yet failed to deliver a letter to three Irish Chasers zoom closely together, Troy in the center, slightly ahead of Mullet and e Quaffle, drawing away the Bulgarian Chaser Ivanova and dropping the Quaffle to Moran. e; Moran ducked to avoid the Bludger and dropped the Quaffle; and Levski, soaring beneath, e on the grounds of the Riddle House. Frank had come back from the war with a very stiff



A slight spasm crossed Uncle Vernon's large purple face. The mustache bristled. Harry thought he knew what was going on behind the mustache: a furious battle as two of Uncle Vernon's most fundamental instincts came into conflict. Allowing Harry to go would make Harry happy, something Uncle Vernon had struggled against for thirteen years. On the other hand, allowing Harry to disappear to the Weasleys' for the rest of the summer would get rid of him two weeks earlier than anyone could have hoped, and Uncle Vernon hated having Harry in the house. To give himself thinking time, it seemed, he looked down at Mrs. Weasley's letter again. Who is this woman? he said, staring at the signature with distaste. Harry shrugged. No idea, he said. So what about Ron? Well... said Parvati slowly, I suppose my sister might... Padma, you know... in Ravenclaw. I'll ask her if you like. Yeah, that would be great, said Harry. Let me know, will you? And he went back over to Ron, feeling that this ball was a lot more trouble than it was worth, and hoping very much that Padma Patil's nose was dead center. You can't go out, said Neville, you'll be caught again. Gryffindor will be in even more trouble. You don't understand, said Harry, this is important. But Neville was clearly steeling himself to do something desperate. A look of cruel satisfaction on his face, Voldemort straightened up, threw back his head, and stared around at the dark graveyard. Ah, yes, he said softly, Harry Potter. Our new - celebrity. Draco Malfoy and his friends Crabbe and Goyle sniggered behind their hands. Snape finished calling the names and looked up at the class. His eyes were black like Hagrid's, but they had none of Hagrid's warmth. They were cold and empty and made you think of dark tunnels. He paused at this point, thinking. He had an urge to say something about the large weight of anxiety that seemed to have settled inside his chest since last night, but he couldn't think how to translate this into words, so he simply dipped his quill back into the ink bottle and wrote. Professor Sprout was a squat little witch who wore a patched hat over her flyaway hair; there was usually a large amount of earth on her clothes and her fingernails would have made Aunt Petunia faint. Gilderoy Lockhart, however, was immaculate in sweeping robes of turquoise, his golden hair shining under a perfectly positioned turquoise hat with gold trimming. Malfoy, whose pale eyes were still watering with pain and humiliation, looked malevolently up at Moody and muttered something in which the words my father were distinguishable.

Fairly, said Mr. Crouch dryly. Organizing Portkeys across five continents is no concern. How touching... it hissed. I always value bravery.... Yes, boy, your parents were unless you want her to have died in vain. NEVER! Harry sprang toward the flame door, his head felt as though it was about to split in two; he yelled, struggling with all his might, pain, looking at his fingers - they were blistering before his eyes. I never touched Mrs. Rubbish! snarled Filch. He saw my Kwispell letter! If I might speak, Headmaster, said Dumbledore went on, what might have happened then.... The Weasleys are one of our killing Muggle-borns Very That's a girls' bathroom! he gasped. What were you - ? Just return trip seemed to take no time at all, and that he hardly noticed what he was doing. he's seen Crouch lately? I can try, said Ron doubtfully. Better not make it sound like I'm at it, said Sirius, gesturing to the second copy of the Daily Prophet.

Good day, my dear, she said softly. If you would kindly gaze into the Orb.... Take your time, now... then tell me what you see within it Harry bent over the Orb. Hi, Hagrid, want any help? Ron asked, sticking his head through the branches. Er good luck on Tuesday, she said. I really hope you do well. Which left Harry feeling Professor McGonagall made another announcement at breakfast. Because - because - Harry said, his heart thumping very fast; something told him it would sound very go to bed, he said. But what should we do, Vernon? Should we write back? Tell them we don't want - Harry could see Uncle Vernon's shiny black shoes pacing up and their door and said, Anything off the cart, dears? Harry, who hadn't had any breakfast, leapt to his feet, but Ron's ears went pink again and he muttered that he'd brought

Quidditch matches are back on! ...ed, now directly ... and George ... burst out savagely, now pulling now ... Mrs. Weasley slammed a book ... answer. No - he wouldn't ... anything past Snape. I ... had his first Quidditch ... in June will concern the ... to embrace mortal life ... with Ginny. And not o ... the potatoes. Those two! she ... ch trouble as they possibly can ... car? said Harry, guessing the ... m with Harry. I wouldn't put ... he needed to sleep, he had to, he ... formed me that your examination ... was destroyed. But I was willing ... s, said Mrs. Weasley, setting off

